Evaluate Business Needs

Given a use case, identify key factors for CRM success that should be included as integration requirements.

Table of Contents

After studying this topic, you should be able to:

- Understand what governance is and how technology organizations benefit from it
- Determine the key principles in implementing Salesforce related to governance
- Identify the key processes that contribute to the success of an integration requirement

Introduction

When designing an integration solution or functionality that has impact on data and processes of an organization, there are key factors to consider to ensure the successful implementation and delivery of the project. In a business that adheres to a good **governance framework**, IT initiatives are always aligned with the company's **vision and strategy**, **priorities are identified** in an exhaustive list of business requirements, a proper **software development lifecycle process** is in place, and other factors. In this topic, key principles are discussed to determine aspects that impact the success of Salesforce integration initiatives.

Governance Framework Factors

TECHNOLOGY TEAM
The group responsible for building, enhancing, and maintaining functionality in an org

BUSINESS UNIT
The group that runs the rest of the business apart from the technology team

END USERS
The group that interacts with org functionality designed to meet business goals

CORE COMMITTEES
Composed of executives and representatives from different business units

KEY PROCESSES
5 important processes involved in the lean governance framework

OPERATING MODELS
The number of orgs, governance frameworks, and level of autonomy of a business entity

Governance

Table of Contents

Governance

A **governance framework** enables a company to have clearly defined **leadership structure**, **strategy and goals**, **processes**, and **policies**. For example, it helps develop the following aspects of a business:

SYSTEMS COMPLIANCE

Security or relevant regulatory requirements related to **system access**, **security**, and **data privacy** should be defined and implemented and ensure that technology systems comply with them.

RISK ASSESSMENT

Integrating a technology into a business process should be **evaluated** in order to clearly identify the **risks** or **potential threats**, the **mitigation procedures**, and other related factors.

Governance

A **governance framework** enables a company to have clearly defined **leadership structure**, **strategy and goals**, **processes**, and **policies**. For example, it helps develop the following aspects of a business:

COST EFFICIENCY

Achieving goals and identifying priorities clearly using standardized and efficient processes enable technology teams, or the business, to **maximize resources**, **minimize waste**, and **reduce costs**.

ADAPTING CHANGE

A company can effectively adapt to **business changes** by focusing on the **priorities** that are established and agreed upon by the organization.

Lean Governance Framework

Salesforce recommends technology organizations to implement the lean governance framework, which is a **lightweight and flexible guideline** for managing **Salesforce environments and projects**.

KEY STAKEHOLDERS

In Salesforce's lean governance framework, there are **key groups** of people that are involved, and each group plays a **significant role**. These stakeholders are:

- Information Technology
- Business Units
- End Users

Key Principles for CRM Success

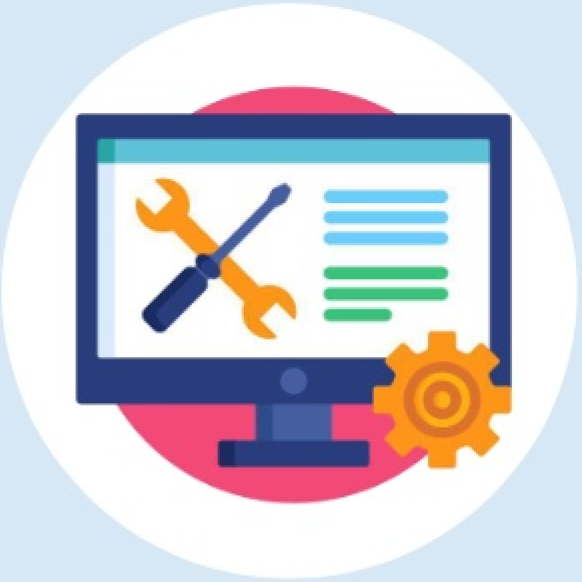
Table of Contents

Key Principles

The following discusses key principles in implementing a **successful Salesforce implementation**.

EXPLAIN THE VALUE

Encouraging team members to change their decision-making processes can be challenging, whether in program/project tasks or routine maintenance. The key is to **articulate the value of the change**, emphasizing benefits like empowering solution architects, developers, and administrators with **upfront design clarity**, **enabling confident** and **faster decision-making**. Additionally, it highlights the importance of explaining to senior leadership the positive outcomes, such as avoiding unnecessary bureaucracy and fostering innovation while consistently effecting decisions and demonstrating impact on organizational goals.

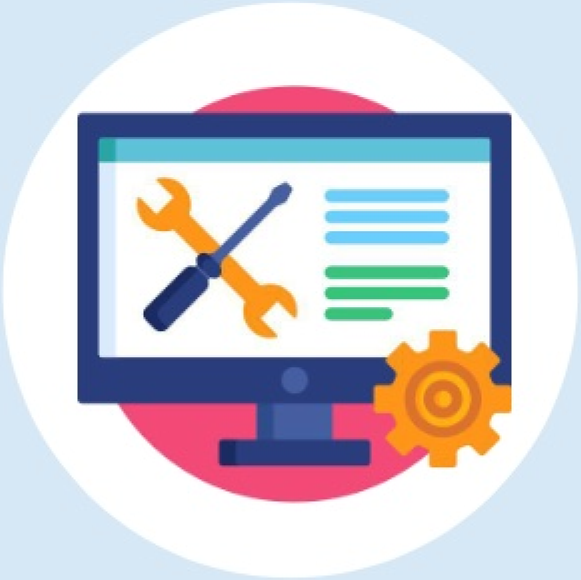


Key Principles

The following discusses key principles in implementing a **successful Salesforce implementation**.

WHEN AND HOW TO GOVERN

Moving from unprincipled to principled governance involves tolerating varying success levels and emphasizing the liberating impact of principles on workflow. While not everyone immediately adopts controls correctly, the passage underscores the need for a thought process aligned with principles in Salesforce design, suggesting the integration of a "principle checkpoint" into governance processes for a smoother adoption.



Principle Checkpoints

Incorporating a "principle checkpoint" into governance procedures helps in making the process **instinctive** and **habitual**. The following is illustrated as an example:

Solution Design

Once requirements have been matched with features and solutions.

Solution Approval

Prior to reaching an agreement on a solution design or a Statement of Work (SoW) outlining a proposed solution.

Architectural Reviews

In the course of routine architecture group meetings and deliberations on suggested modifications.

Change Management

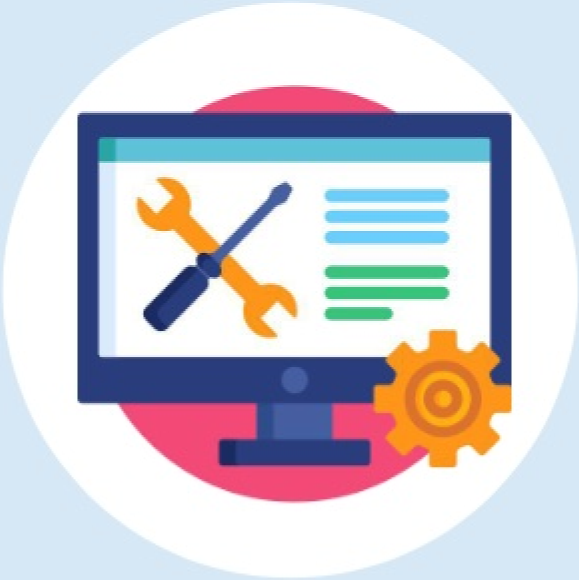
Prior to granting approval for the deployment of a release or change.

Key Principles

The following discusses key principles in implementing a **successful Salesforce implementation**.

MANAGING THE PRINCIPLE LIFECYCLE

Essential for decision-making, principles **should remain stable** but may **require adaptation** to evolving business and technical demands. There is no set frequency for reviewing them; factors such as major changes in business plans, IT strategy, upcoming projects, new skills in the Salesforce team, or features in Salesforce deployment can trigger a review. Involving existing **governance groups**, including business and IT stakeholders, ensures consistency, with the **final decision** typically resting with the enterprise architecture team or the most senior IT person.



Principle Lifecycle Management

Standard change management can be used to oversee principle lifecycles. For example, the following details can be recorded for managing a lifecycle.

Created By
Who created the principle and the date when is was created

Updated By
Who last updated the principle and the date when it was updated

Owner
Who is responsible for wording updates, version control, and other queries

Version
The version of the current principle. A versioning scheme should be used.

Status
The status of the principle. Is it draft, final, retired, etc.?

Review Date
When the principle is reviewed for accuracy and relevance

Retirement Date
When the principle has been retired and removed from use

Roles and Responsibilities

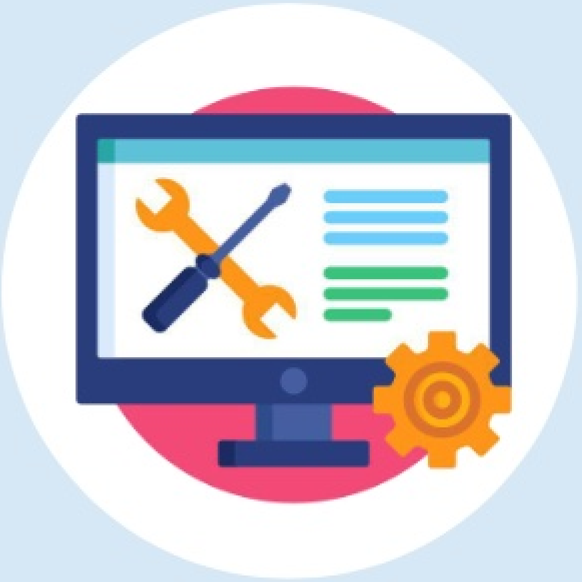
Table of Contents

Roles and Responsibilities

The following describes the roles and responsibilities in Salesforce's **lean governance framework**.

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

This group refers to the **technology team** that covers roles such as Salesforce administrators and Salesforce developers in the company. The company relies on this group for deploying releases that include **new functionality**, **fixes**, or **feature enhancements** in the org. In addition to **building** and **maintaining customizations** in Salesforce, the group is responsible for **defining release schedules**, **system testing**, as well as providing **system support**. It is important that this group establishes a deep partnership with the business units in the company.



Roles and Responsibilities

The following describes the roles and responsibilities in Salesforce's **lean governance framework**.

BUSINESS UNITS

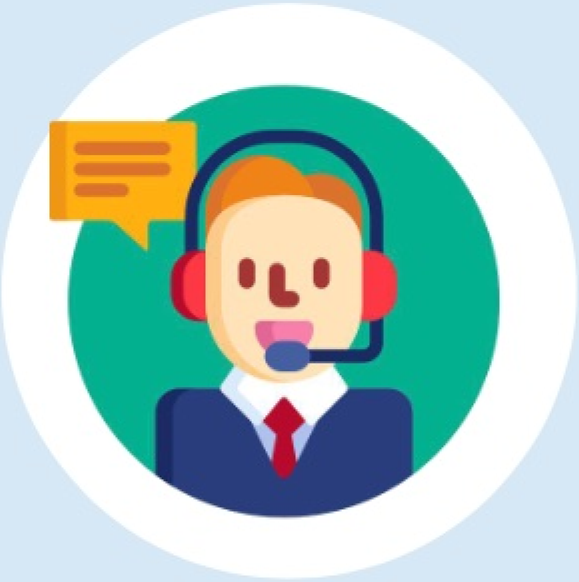
This group refers to the different **business divisions** or the people in charge of running the rest of the business outside the technology team. A business unit is in charge of responsibilities such as **owning and managing budgets**, **onboarding users**, **gathering end-user feedback** as well as **designating product owners**, which refers to a role that is utilized in an agile process responsible for managing business requirements and identifying backlog items that need prioritization.

Roles and Responsibilities

The following describes the roles and responsibilities in Salesforce's **lean governance framework**.

END USERS

This group refers to the people who use Salesforce to complete their daily tasks. These users interact with the **customizations**, **functionality**, or **features** that are deployed in the org by the **technology team** based on the requirements identified by the **business team**. It is important to involve key representatives from this user group in decision-making processes as they provide valuable feedback.



Key Components

Table of Contents

Key Processes

The **lean governance framework** consists of a lightweight governance structure used for developing, implementing, and managing IT initiatives and involves **5 key processes**.

VISION & STRATEGY
Defining the reasons why a project is happening and how to measure its success

BUSINESS BACKLOG
Determining which requirements to prioritize based on the business goals

COMMUNICATION STRATEGY
Aligning stakeholders and driving user adoption through proper communication

TECHNICAL CHANGE CONTROL
Delivering functionality through a software development lifecycle

DATA ARCHITECTURE & MANAGEMENT
Designing and implementing a data strategy plan for efficient data integration

Vision & Strategy

The **vision** describes what the business wants to do, and the **strategy** defines how to achieve the vision. They should be regularly **reviewed** and **updated** as necessary.

VISION AND STRATEGY

The **reason** why a project is started, the **strategy** that is going to be used, and **criteria** for measuring its success are determined. The vision & strategy is expressed in business terms on a document and should not mention any technology or systems. The following describes some of the **benefits** of having this process:

- Establishes a clear **decision-making process** that identifies **priorities**
- Drives **ownership** of the project among the business and IT teams
- Establishes a **deep partnership** between the business and IT teams
- Achieves the business goals and strategies in a **timely manner**

Vision & Strategy

The **vision** describes what the business wants to do, and the **strategy** defines how to achieve the vision. They should be regularly **reviewed** and **updated** as necessary.

NO VISION AND STRATEGY

Lacking a vision and strategy will result in **unfavorable outcomes** such as:

- Effort and resources are spent on requirements that are **unnecessary** or solutions that contribute **low business value**
- There is **lack of alignment and focus** among the business and IT teams
- **Budgets** are not managed or controlled due to unforeseen circumstances
- There is **low user adoption** since the solution is not effective and suboptimal

Business Backlog

The business backlog lists **business requirements** related to a project or multiple projects and should be regularly reviewed and updated as necessary.

BUSINESS BACKLOG

The business backlog is based on the **vision and strategy** and is formulated by internal team members who are knowledgeable of Salesforce's **capabilities and limitations** and able to determine the cost and duration to complete a task and identify which ones to **prioritize** in the list of requirements. The following describes some of the **benefits** of having this process:

- Drives **standardization** of business processes
- Identifies where **resources** should be invested
- Delivers business outcomes based on **business goals and strategies**
- **Risks** are identified by highlighting **dependencies**
- Aligns the **focus** between all stakeholders

Business Backlog

The business backlog lists **business requirements** related to a project or multiple projects and should be regularly reviewed and updated as necessary.

POOR BUSINESS BACKLOG

Poor implementation of a business backlog will result in **unfavorable outcomes** such as:

- Time and resources expended on initiatives that are **unnecessary**
- Building functionality that **already exists** or **included** in an incoming Salesforce release update as a result from lack of due diligence
- **Budgets** to supposedly cover implementation costs are **exceeded**
- **Lack of synergy** between the business and IT teams
- Deployed enhancements **break functionality** of other business teams
- **Dependency issues** may arise due to lack of planning

Technical Change Control

In technical change control, the **software development lifecycle**, **technical governance**, and **release cadence** are defined to maximize productivity and minimize system instability.

TECHNICAL CHANGE CONTROL

The processes that relate to **development**, **testing**, and **deployment** should be defined and applied using the **best practices** and **architectural standards** recommended by Salesforce. Also, a **release cadence** should be defined to determine appropriate release schedules. The following describes some of the **benefits** of having this process:

- Delivers quality solutions since Salesforce **recommendations** and **best practices** are being followed
- Drives **agility** and **velocity** due to developing solutions using a robust software development lifecycle process
- **Ability to adapt** when business goals change

Technical Change Control

In technical change control, the **software development lifecycle**, **technical governance**, and **release cadence** are defined to maximize productivity and minimize system instability.

POOR TECHNICAL CHANGE CONTROL

Poor implementation of a technical change control will result in **unfavorable outcomes** such as:

- **Poor quality** or **instability** of a solution as a release can potentially impact another release due to lack of regression testing
- **Lack of agility** due to poorly implemented solutions, or **technical debt**, as a result of lacking standards, guidelines, and processes
- **Developer resources** are exerted on **non-essential functionality** instead of meeting core business requirements

Data Architecture & Management

A **data strategy** should be established on how data is **architectured** and **managed** in a requirement.

DATA ARCHITECTURE & MANAGEMENT

How data is **modeled**, **migrated**, **backed up**, **archived**, or how it **interacts** with another system should be defined. Once the data architecture is developed, it can then be translated into a physical Salesforce implementation. The following describes some of the **benefits** of having this process:

- Drives **consistency** and **simplicity** due to a **streamlined data model** that is used across Salesforce applications
- Keeps the org clean and well-structured as the role of each **custom field** is clearly identified and understood
- Improves **large data volume handling** and **org performance**

Data Architecture & Management

A **data strategy** should be established on how data is **architectured** and **managed** in a requirement.

POOR DATA ARCHITECTURE & MANAGEMENT

Poor data architecture & management will result in **unfavorable outcomes** such as:

- **Delayed deployment** due to inefficient data migration processes
- **Duplicate data** are not identified or caught
- Unnecessary **custom fields** lead to technical debt
- Complex integration challenges as a result of **poor data mapping** with external systems
- Impact on **costs** and **org performance** due to expanding data volumes and org complexity

Communications Strategy

A **communications strategy** should be defined to ensure that **everyone involved** and **affected** by a project is not only **informed** but also has a **voice** in the process.

COMMUNICATIONS STRATEGY

A good communications strategy ensures that **all stakeholders** - the technology team, business team, and end users - understand the business value of a solution that is being undertaken. For example, end users should be made to understand how it's going to **improve the process** and **increase productivity** and also encouraged to **provide feedback**. Any disagreements between stakeholders should be openly discussed to keep all groups aligned with each other. Also, an **official communications channel** should be defined and recognized by all stakeholders to avoid unnecessary communication methods and noise.

Communications Strategy

A **communications strategy** should be defined to ensure that **everyone involved** and **affected** by a project is not only **informed** but also has a **voice** in the process.

POOR COMMUNICATIONS STRATEGY

Poor communications strategy will result in **unfavorable outcomes** such as:

- Stakeholders are **not aligned** with each other
- Business goals are **not being achieved** by the solution
- End users **do not understand** the purpose of the solution leading to **low user adoption**
- **Wrong decisions** are made due to poor decision-making process that result to wasted time and resources

Use Case

Table of Contents

Scenario

SCENARIO

A company needs to integrate their Salesforce org with a middleware and an Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system that would allow their users to easily move data across systems and streamline their processes respectively across all the different business divisions in the organization. The company has arranged a meeting with key people to discuss how to move forward with the project and ensure that the solution not only will be developed and delivered efficiently, but also should be adopted well by the users that will be impacted by the changes.

Solution

SOLUTION

When implementing integration or functionality that impact data or processes in a business, it is essential to determine the vision and strategy, business requirement priorities, software development processes, and the data governance aspects of the company. It must also be ensured that all stakeholders are informed and heard of through a proper communication channel. This allows end users, for example, to fully understand why there is a change in the existing process and ultimately drive user adoption. The type of operating model which refers to the number of orgs and governance frameworks in effect and the amount of autonomy that is allowed in each org will impact the scope of the project and how it should be delivered to successfully meet requirements.